

UNITED NATIONS **NATIONS UNIES**
DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL AFFAIRS

**ITALIAN FELLOWSHIPS PROGRAMME
FOR TECHNICAL COOPERATION
CAPACITY BUILDING AND HUMAN RESOURCES DEVELOPMENT
2025-2026**

Fellowship Award Specification

**United Nations Officer for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (OCHA)
Mozambique Country Office**

1. General Information

<u>Title:</u>	UN Fellow
<u>Orientation Workshop dates:</u>	May 2026 (tbc)
<u>Assignment in the field dates:</u>	May 2026 – May 2027 (tbc)
<u>Duty Station:</u>	Maputo, Mozambique
<u>Sector of assignment:</u>	Associate Humanitarian Affairs, Coordination, Reporting

2. Supervision

<u>Name of the Direct Supervisor:</u>	Mr. Matthew Mpitapita
<u>Title of the Supervisor:</u>	Head of Field Coordination Unit
<u>Name of the Second Supervisor:</u>	Mr Bony Mpaka
<u>Title of the Second Supervisor:</u>	Deputy Head of Office

3. Background information

ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE

OCHA has been present in Mozambique since March 2019, initially through a Humanitarian Advisory Team (HAT) deployed in the aftermath of Cyclones Idai and Kenneth. The HAT supported the coordination and response to a series of crises, including the conflict and displacement in northern Mozambique, recurrent climatic shocks (cyclones, floods, droughts), and the COVID-19 pandemic.

Building on this footprint, OCHA progressively expanded and, as of January 2022, transitioned into a fully-fledged Country Office (CO). Through the establishment of the CO, OCHA has been strengthening its pivotal role in galvanizing, coordinating and supporting humanitarian action in Mozambique, focusing on its core functions: coordination, advocacy, humanitarian financing and information management.

The CO is structured around two main offices:

- Pemba (leadership, operational coordination, access/CMCoord).
- Maputo (humanitarian financing, comms/IM, liaison with Government, admin);

Internally, the CO is organized into specialized units:

- Field Coordination Unit
- Communications & Information Management Unit,
- Access/Civil–Military Coordination & Security Unit,
- Administration & Finance Unit, among others.

HUMANITARIAN SITUATION IN THE COUNTRY

Mozambique is grappling with a multi-layered crisis driven by conflict, climate disasters and disease outbreaks. In the north, a non-State Armed Groups (NSAGs) insurgency continues to generate new surges of violence and displacement. Civilians face killings, abductions, sexual violence and the destruction of homes and services. Humanitarian operations are frequently disrupted when insecurity spikes.

Despite significant relief efforts, the scale of need outpaced response capacity. By mid-2025, humanitarian partners had reached roughly 782,000 people in conflict-affected areas — about 71 % of those targeted there — while nationwide only around one-third of people in need had been reached. Access constraints, chronic underfunding and repeated shocks continue to erode coverage.

Hundreds of thousands of internally displaced people (IDPs) remain in Cabo Delgado, Nampula and Niassa. Many are unable to return home due to ongoing insecurity, landmines and the destruction of housing and infrastructure. Those attempting to return often find farmland degraded by droughts and cyclones, leaving them without livelihoods. Protection risks are acute: civilians are targeted during attacks and while moving between communities; and insecurity often forces humanitarian actors to scale back, leaving the most vulnerable with minimal support.

Successive cyclones and floods continue to devastate Mozambique and undermine resilience. Cyclone Chido (December 2024) damaged or destroyed more than 155,000 homes, caused major economic losses and wiped-out health and education assets. Cyclone Dikeledi (January 2025) hit central and northern provinces, affecting over 70,000 people and disrupting schools, health facilities and roads. Cyclone Jude (March 2025) affected over 375,000 people, damaging or destroying more than 80,000 houses and public infrastructure. In total, over 1 million people were affected by the three cyclones together. These shocks repeatedly erode recovery gains, exhaust household coping capacity and complicate humanitarian logistics.

In conflict-affected districts, more than half of health facilities are non-functional. Thousands of consultations are suspended each week because of insecurity or damaged infrastructure. Cholera and other waterborne diseases remain a constant threat, particularly in crowded displacement sites and flood-hit areas where water and sanitation systems have broken down.

Latest projections (April–September 2025) indicate about 2.1 million people across Mozambique are facing Crisis or worse (IPC Phase 3+) food insecurity, including roughly 143,000 in Emergency (IPC 4) conditions. This represents a slight improvement from earlier lean-season forecasts but still signals

severe, widespread hunger. In the north (Cabo Delgado and neighboring districts), persistent violence and displacement disrupt planting, market access and humanitarian food pipelines. Many households remain cut off from stable income or harvests.

In central and southern regions, recurrent droughts and erratic rainfall have depleted reserves and forced early adoption of negative coping strategies such as reducing meals, selling productive assets or migrating temporarily.

4. Duties, responsibilities and output expectations:

Within the framework of the Fellowships Programme for Technical Cooperation Capacity Building and Human Resources Development, under the supervision of the Head of Field Coordination Unit, the candidate will perform the following duties:

- Assists in the inter-agency/inter-sectoral coordination of international humanitarian/emergency assistance for complex emergency/disaster situations, ensuring the necessary support.
- Assists in the design and preparation of studies on humanitarian, disaster, emergency relief and related issues and in various follow-up activities.
- Supports researches, analyzes and presents information gathered from diverse sources on assigned topics/issues.
- Assists on contribution and preparation of various written documents, e.g., drafts sections of studies, prioritization process for assessments and response, background papers, policy guidelines, parliamentary documents etc.
- Supports on development and maintenance of reference/resource information on specific topics or policy-related issues; responds to various inquiries and information requests internally and externally.
- Assists in the production of appeals for international assistance; ensures the proper use and spending of donor contributions channeled through OCHA.
- Assists in the organization of meetings, seminars, conferences, workshops, etc. with other agencies and partners to facilitate exchanges of professional expertise and views on specific humanitarian-related subjects/issues; serves as reporter to such events.
- Maintains awareness of current humanitarian affairs and related issues, to include relevant political, policy, gender considerations or other developments in specific subject area, country or region concerned.
- Participates in technical assistance, disaster assessment or other missions.
- Participates in project/programme formulation and mobilization of relevant resources.
- Performs other duties as required.

5. Qualifications and Experience

Education

Advanced university degree (Master's degree or equivalent) in political science, social science, international studies, public administration, economics, engineering, earth sciences or a related field.

Work experience

- A minimum of one year of relevant work experience in humanitarian affairs, emergency preparedness, crisis/emergency relief management, rehabilitation, development, or related area is required.
- Experience working in the context of complex emergencies or natural disaster response is highly valued.
- Work experience in the field (actual setting where a mission or project is being implemented) is desirable.
- Experience in the region is desirable.
- Experience in the UN Common System or a comparable international organization is desirable.

Languages

English and French are the working languages of the UN Secretariat. For this position, fluency in English is required. Knowledge of Portuguese and or Swahili is an advantage.

Other skills

Humanitarian financing, operational coordination, needs assessments, drafting/reporting.

Competencies

PROFESSIONALISM: Shows pride in work and in achievements; Demonstrates professional competence and mastery of subject matter; Is conscientious and efficient in meeting commitments, observing deadlines and achieving results; Is motivated by professional rather than personal concerns; Shows persistence when faced with difficult problems or challenges; Remains calm in stressful situations; takes responsibility for incorporating gender perspectives and ensuring the equal participation of women and men in all areas of work.

COMMUNICATION: Speaks and writes clearly and effectively; Listens to others, correctly interprets messages from others and responds appropriately; Asks questions to clarify, and exhibits interest in having two-way communication; Tailors language, tone, style and format to match the audience; Demonstrates openness in sharing information and keeping people informed

ACCOUNTABILITY: Takes ownership of all responsibilities and honors commitments; Delivers outputs for which one has responsibility within prescribed time, cost and quality standards; Operates in compliance with organizational regulations and rules; Supports subordinates, provides oversight and takes responsibility for delegated assignments; Takes personal responsibility for his/her own shortcomings and those of the work unit, where applicable.

6. Learning Elements

At the end of the assignment the Fellow will be able to:

- Support monitoring, analysis and report on the humanitarian situation in a country;
- draft a variety of written outputs including daily updates, situation reports, background papers, donors' reports, presentations, talking points for senior UN officials, etc.
- draft and edit different kind of information products, including flash updates, humanitarian snapshots and dashboards, access snapshots as well as press releases, to support corporate communication and advocacy.
- Support on screening and cross-check internal and external reports, information and communication materials for accuracy and consistency.
- Support liaison with national and international partners, stakeholders and media.

7. Content and methodology of supervision

Establishment of a Work Plan: During the first month of the assignment, the Fellow will work jointly with his/her direct supervisor to finalize an agreed upon work plan. The final work plan will be discussed and mutually agreed to by the Fellow and his/her supervisor.

Regular meetings will be held with the supervisor to establish key priorities and tasks as well as to discuss any challenges and/or areas of improvement.

8. Living conditions in the country

General living environment

Maputo, Mozambique's capital and largest city, offers comparatively good living conditions for international humanitarian workers. It is a coastal urban center with a vibrant cultural scene, supermarkets, restaurants, cafés and basic leisure facilities. Most international staff live in apartments or houses in secure neighborhoods such as Sommerschield, Polana and Costa do Sol, where reliable utilities and internet are available, though power and water cuts can occur occasionally. The city has several private hospitals and clinics providing general and specialist care, but for complex medical needs most agencies recommend evacuation to South Africa.

Security and mobility

Maputo is generally calm and considered a moderate security environment compared to conflict-affected northern provinces. Petty crime (bag snatching, car break-ins, scams) is the main risk, especially after dark, so staff are advised to take usual urban precautions and use reputable taxis or private cars rather than public transport. Road conditions within the city are fair but driving standards can be erratic and traffic congested. Travel to other provinces — especially the north — may require additional security clearance or air travel due to poor road infrastructure and localized insecurity.

Cost of living and social amenities

The cost of living for expatriates is moderate: rents in secure areas are significant but manageable with a UN or NGO salary; imported goods can be expensive while local produce is affordable. Maputo offers a range of international schools, fitness centers and recreational options, though choices are more limited than in major regional hubs such as Johannesburg. There is an active humanitarian and diplomatic community with social networks and professional gatherings, making integration relatively smooth. Overall, Maputo provides a comfortable and functional base for humanitarian operations, though staff should expect occasional service disruptions, a relatively high cost for imported items, and the need to maintain prudent personal security awareness.